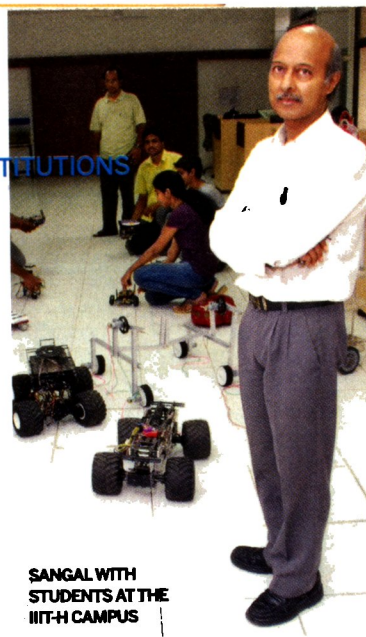


The Game Changers INSTITUTIONS

INTERNATIONAL INSTITUTE
OF INFORMATION
TECHNOLOGY Hyderabad

IIIT FIGURES

Set up in 1998, the International Institute of Information Technology, Hyderabad (IIIT-H), in 2009, was recognised by the US-based National Science Foundation as one of the top research institutions in India for US graduate students to take up research fellowships. An unusual honour for the young institute which the first IIIT to be set up under a not-for-profit public-private partnership model involving the Andhra Pradesh government and eminent people from education and industry. "We have evolved strong research programmes with emphasis on the development of technology and applications, which can be transferred for use to industry and society," says director Rajeev Sangal, 55. What makes IIIT-H stu-



SANGAL WITH STUDENTS AT THE IIIT-H CAMPUS

A PRASHAKAR RAO

The institute has over **85** Ph.D and 360 M.S. by Research students.

dents stand apart is the freedom to opt for coursework and research simultaneously. Today, it has the largest research groups in the country working in Natural Language Processing, Speech and Computer Vision. *by Amarnath K. Menon*

REWACHAND BHOJWANI
ACADEMY Pune

FUN AND GRADES

Every Wednesday, when students call over Pune trundle into school with their collars buttoned up and ties knotted, it is an altogether different scene at the Rewachand Bhojwani Academy, where children clamber in joyously, dressed in multi-hued salwar-kurtas or dhotis. It's the no-uniform day, when they enjoy the colours of traditional wear. "Education is a fine balance between academics and real world experiences," says principal Sharda Rao. Brainchild of well-known educationist Madhavi Kapoor, the school was established in 1995. The mantra is inclusive and integrated education. Students with learning and physical disabilities share study and game time with regular children. There are no separate classes for them though

ANUBHUTI SCHOOL Maharashtra

BUILDING ON TRADITION

During the sweltering summer heat, when children of most schools are struggling to complete their vacation projects, the students of Anubhuti School are taking a break. Used to the trappings of a regular school, they ask their teachers what projects would be assigned to them. "I told them, why should anyone work during vacation?" says Krishnakumar, a History, Sanskrit and English teacher. Reinventing education while remaining rooted in culture is what Anubhuti, spread over 100 acres near Jalgaon in Maharashtra, aims to achieve. As director Nisha Jain, 42, says, "Our motto is experiential learning. We want to do away with learning by rote and make it a project-based experience." According to the vision of

the founder, Bhavarlal Jain, the school follows a gurukul model where students and teachers live on the same premises and go through daily lessons and chores together. Started in 2007 with classes up to VII, the school now goes up to Class IX. It believes in and follows water conservation, use of solar power and

recycling of water. These initiatives got Anubhuti the Centre for Science and Environment Green School Award in 2008. *by Jhilmil Motihar*

Anubhuti started with 66 students in 2007; it has **213** today.

THE SCHOOL FIRMLY BELIEVES IN EXPERIENTIAL LEARNING

